



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Promotion

MARKETING COMMUNICATION SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function.
2. Identify communications channels used in sales promotion.
3. Explain the types of promotion.
4. Explain types of advertising media.
5. Explain the use of social media for digital marketing.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the marketing communications manager for THE SPOTLIGHT CAFE, a trendy coffee shop that has become popular with young professionals in the local area. The owner (judge) wants you to develop a promotional plan to increase foot traffic during weekday mornings.

THE SPOTLIGHT CAFE is known for its cozy atmosphere, locally sourced coffee beans, and weekly open mic nights. The majority of the current customer base visits during afternoons and weekends, but weekday mornings have been slow. The cafe offers a variety of coffee drinks, breakfast pastries, and specialty teas, and the owner wants to encourage more customers to stop in before heading to work.

The primary target market for THE SPOTLIGHT CAFE'S weekday morning promotion is young professionals between the ages of 22 and 35. These individuals typically work in nearby office buildings or are on their way to their first job of the day. They value convenience, quality, and a sense of community, often preferring local businesses that offer unique, personalized experiences over large chains. This group is tech-savvy, heavily engaged on social media platforms such as Instagram and LinkedIn, and likely to respond to promotions that emphasize time-saving options.

The owner (judge) believes that a well-thought-out promotional plan focused on weekday mornings can significantly boost sales. The owner (judge) has asked you to:

- Propose specific promotional tactics to increase traffic during weekday mornings.
- Recommend a combination of social media platforms and email marketing to communicate the promotions effectively.
- Suggest creative ideas for in-store promotions or limited-time offers that align with the cafe's brand.

You will present your promotional plan to the owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How will you measure the success of these promotions?
2. What specific time-saving options or convenience-focused features will you highlight to appeal to young professionals who may be in a rush?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Identify communications channels used in sales promotion?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the types of promotion?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Explain types of advertising media?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Explain the use of social media for digital marketing?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						